OCR H446 / PAPER 1 / UNIT 1.5

Legal, moral, cultural and ethical issues

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H446/01 / REVISION

Understand it. Model it. Try it. Check it.

Use this chapter to understand the theory, follow worked models and practise independently.

TWO SPECIFICATION FAMILIES

1.5.1 COMPUTING-RELATED LEGISLATION

Data protection, computer misuse, copyright and investigatory powers

1.5.2 MORAL AND ETHICAL ISSUES

Nine specified contexts: workforce, AI, environment, expression, culture and privacy

FOUR PASSES FOR EVERY TOPIC

01 UNDERSTAND

Learn precise concepts and stakeholder context.

02 MODEL

Follow a decision trace or scenario.

03 TRY

Answer original exam-style prompts.

04 CHECK

Self-mark, correct and explain.

CRITICAL LEGAL UPDATE

The OCR specification names the Data Protection Act 1998 and RIPA 2000. Those are historical specification references. Current UK law includes UK GDPR / DPA 2018 as amended in 2025, and later investigatory-powers legislation. Always distinguish an exam listing from present law.

In evaluation answers, explain stakeholder consequences and reach a justified conclusion.

1.5 / SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST

Every named context is covered

Use a linked topic row to jump directly to its Understand page. Then follow Model, Try and Check.

SPEC	TOPIC	PAGES
1.5.1(a)	Data protection: old and current law	3-6
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KEY EXAM DISCIPLINE

A-level extended responses should identify stakeholders, apply the scenario, weigh plausible benefits and harms, and reach a justified judgement. Avoid a generic “pros and cons” list.

Sources checked (30 Oct 2026): OCR H446 v2.7; ICO on UK GDPR, DPA 2018 and DUAA 2025; CPS/NCA on CMA; GOV.UK copyright; legislation.gov.uk on investigatory powers.

Source links: OCR specification | ICO data law updates | CPS computer misuse | GOV.UK copyright

1.5.1(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Know the named OCR Act and the modern legal framework

OCR H446 v2.7 still lists the Data Protection Act 1998. Do not describe the 1998 Act as the current UK data-protection framework: today the UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 apply, as amended by the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

OCR LISTING

DPA 1998 is explicitly named in specification 1.5.1(a); it is historical legislation.

CURRENT FRAMEWORK

The UK GDPR and DPA 2018 govern personal-data processing in the UK.

2025 UPDATE

The Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 amended, but did not replace, that framework.

VISUAL EXPLANATION / FOLLOW THE RELATIONSHIP

1998

OCR names

Historic Act

2018

Core law

DPA + UK GDPR

2025

Updates

DUAA amendments

The 2025 changes AMEND; they do not replace the UK GDPR and DPA 2018.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

For a real organisation in 2026, refer to the UK GDPR and DPA 2018 as amended, while recognising the DPA 1998 in the OCR specification.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Personal data** — Identifiable person
- **Processing** — Use of personal data
- **Controller** — Decides purposes
- **Amendment** — Changes existing law

1.5.1(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

A revision answer about a new school attendance app

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Identify	Attendance records + names	Those records can identify individual pupils.
2. Specification	DPA 1998 named in H446	Recognise the historic Act without treating it as current.
3. Current law	UK GDPR + DPA 2018	Modern processing must have a lawful basis and meet principles.
4. Updates	DUAA 2025 amendments	Changes some rules and processes; does not repeal the framework.
5. Apply	Minimise, secure, retain appropriately	Only collect required data and restrict access.

EXAM TRANSFER

For a real organisation in 2026, refer to the UK GDPR and DPA 2018 as amended, while recognising the DPA 1998 in the OCR specification.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.1(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 4 MARKS

The H446 specification names the Data Protection Act 1998. Explain why a new school app should not rely on that Act alone as its description of current UK data-protection law.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Identify two safeguards a school should use when processing pupil attendance data and explain why each is appropriate.

1.5.1(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 4 MARKS

- The DPA 1998 is named historically in the OCR content.
- The current core framework is UK GDPR and DPA 2018, amended by DUAA 2025.
- A current school app must comply with the applicable present-day obligations.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Limit collection to necessary attendance fields; reduces exposure.
- Apply appropriate access controls; restricts unauthorised viewing.
- Set justified retention periods; prevents keeping data longer than needed.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

The 2025 Act amended existing rules; it did not replace UK GDPR or the DPA 2018.

Green pen: Keep one phrase for the exam listing and another for modern law; do not merge the dates.

1.5.1(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Make a data flow lawful, fair and secure

Personal data creates responsibilities through its collection, use, disclosure and deletion. A system may be technically secure but still breach data-protection principles if its collection or use is unjustified.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

PRINCIPLES

Lawful, fair, transparent, limited in purpose and quantity, accurate, secure and not kept unnecessarily.

RIGHTS

People may have rights to information, access, rectification, erasure and other protections; rights have conditions or exceptions.

ACCOUNTABILITY

A controller should demonstrate compliance through governance, assessment and appropriate safeguards.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Collect necessary data → **Explain purpose and lawful basis** → **Limit access and retention** → **Support rights and accountability**

Minimisation is not the same as encryption: collecting fewer fields and securing stored fields solve different risks.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Identify the exact data, the purpose, a lawful basis and a proportional control. Do not assume that collecting data is always unlawful or that consent is always required.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Lawful basis** — Legal ground to process
- **Minimisation** — Only required data
- **Retention** — Justified storage period
- **Transparency** — Explain the processing

1.5.1(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Redesign a sports-club membership form

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Audit	Name, contact, shoe size, health details	Some fields may not be necessary; health data needs additional safeguards.
2. Purpose	Contact for fixtures	Explain why contact details are needed.
3. Reduce	Do not collect shoe size by default	Data minimisation limits unnecessary personal data.
4. Protect	Role-based permissions + encryption	Reduce exposure and unauthorised access.
5. Review	Retention, accuracy and requests	Delete when no longer needed; provide appropriate rights processes.

EXAM TRANSFER

Identify the exact data, the purpose, a lawful basis and a proportional control. Do not assume that collecting data is always unlawful or that consent is always required.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.1(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

A club collects names, dietary details and home addresses for an online newsletter. Evaluate two privacy issues and propose specific changes.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain the difference between data minimisation and data security using one practical example of each.

1.5.1(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Question whether each field is necessary for the newsletter purpose.
- Dietary details may be particularly sensitive and unjustified for this purpose.
- Collect only needed contact details, explain the use and set retention.
- Use limited access or encryption to protect retained records.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Minimisation reduces how much data is collected, e.g. no date of birth if unnecessary.
- Security protects retained data, e.g. access permissions and encryption.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Consent is one possible lawful basis, not a universal requirement for every use of personal data.

Green pen: Connect every safeguard to an identified risk instead of giving a generic security list.

1.5.1(b) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Authorisation matters more than technical skill

The Computer Misuse Act 1990 targets unauthorised access and other unauthorised acts affecting computer systems. Relevant offences differ according to access, intention and resulting or risked harm.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

SECTION 1

Knowingly attempting to secure unauthorised access to computer material.

SECTION 2

Unauthorised access with intent to commit or facilitate a further serious offence.

SECTION 3

Unauthorised acts intending, or reckless as to, impairment of a system, access or data.

VISUAL EXPLANATION / FOLLOW THE RELATIONSHIP

S1

Access

Knowingly unauthorised

S2

Purpose

Further offence intended

S3

Impact

Intended/reckless impairment

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Describe the unauthorised action, the relevant intention and its effect. There are additional modern provisions beyond the three core introductory sections.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Unauthorised Without permission

Section 1 Unauthorised access

Section 2 Further offence intent

Section 3 Impairment / recklessness

1.5.1(b) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Classify three cybersecurity scenarios

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Student	Uses guessed credentials on a classmate account	Likely unauthorised access under s1.
2. Criminal	Accesses account intending to steal funds	May involve s2 because of further-offence intent.
3. Disruption	Launches traffic to take a site offline	May involve s3 because the act impairs availability.
4. Permission	Pen-tests own authorised lab	Authorisation and agreed scope change the legal analysis.
5. Extension	Severe damage to critical systems	Other modern CMA provisions such as s3ZA may be relevant.

EXAM TRANSFER

Describe the unauthorised action, the relevant intention and its effect. There are additional modern provisions beyond the three core introductory sections.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.1(b) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

A student guesses a password, reads an account and later launches a denial-of-service attack against a school service. Explain which CMA concerns arise.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why a security researcher needs explicit scope and permission even when they intend to improve security.

1.5.1(b) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Guessing/logging in without permission can constitute unauthorised access (s1).
- The traffic attack may impair service availability and can engage s3.
- The circumstances, knowledge and intention determine offences.
- Explain real impact, e.g. legitimate users unable to access service.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Without permission, accessing systems can be unauthorised.
- Authorisation defines which systems and tests are permitted.
- A helpful motive alone is not equivalent to permission.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Hacking is not one single offence: the precise conduct and required mental element matter.

Green pen: In a response, label the section and prove it with a scenario-specific detail.

1.5.1(c) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Code, images and music can have separate permissions

The Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 protects many creative works including computer programs. Copyright generally arises automatically; permitted use depends on ownership, licences and applicable exceptions.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

PROTECTED WORK

Source code, artwork, recorded audio and written content can be protected independently.

LICENCE

Permission sets conditions of use, modification or redistribution; read the actual terms.

EXCEPTIONS

Some uses are permitted by law, but educational use does not mean unlimited copying or posting online.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Identify original asset → **Find owner and licence** → **Check proposed reuse** → **Credit and comply / seek permission**

A working program on a public website is not automatically public-domain software; source availability alone is not a licence.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Distinguish legal permission from ethical credit. Crediting a creator alone does not automatically grant rights to copy their work.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Copyright** Automatic protection
- **Licence** Usage permission
- **Attribution** Credit creator
- **Infringement** Use beyond rights

1.5.1(c) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Publish a student game with four external assets

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Source	Student-written game code	Identify ownership and any collaborators.
2. Image	Screenshot from a commercial game	Check permission or an applicable exception; do not assume free reuse.
3. Music	Track found on a streaming service	Streaming access does not grant redistribution rights.
4. Library	Open-source graphics library	Read and comply with the relevant software licence.
5. Publish	Credits + licences + replacement assets	Use permitted material and keep attribution where required.

EXAM TRANSFER

Distinguish legal permission from ethical credit. Crediting a creator alone does not automatically grant rights to copy their work.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.1(c) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

A programmer uses public GitHub code and a commercial music track in a published app. Discuss legal and ethical responsibilities.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why an open-source software licence is not the same thing as work being free of copyright.

1.5.1(c) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Publicly visible code may still have copyright; check its licence and comply with terms.
- Commercial music requires permission or another legal basis for use.
- Licences may impose attribution or redistribution conditions.
- The developer should document permitted sources or replace assets.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Copyright protection still applies to open-source work.
- Its licence grants specific rights under stated conditions.
- A user must comply with those conditions when copying/modifying/distributing.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Attribution is important but does not alone authorise reproduction or distribution.

Green pen: Name the asset and the permission needed rather than writing only “copyright applies”.

1.5.1(d) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Separate public safety powers from privacy protections

OCR explicitly names the Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000 (RIPA). Investigatory powers have since evolved, including under the Investigatory Powers Act 2016. These laws address particular investigative activities and provide restrictions and safeguards.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

RIPA 2000

OCR-named legislation associated with specified interception and surveillance powers and regulatory controls.

IPA 2016

Modern framework for certain interception, communications-data and equipment-interference powers.

PROPORTIONALITY

Consider legitimate aim, necessity, intrusiveness and applicable approval/oversight safeguards.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Identify legitimate aim → **Specify what data is sought** → **Check lawful authority and safeguards** → **Balance against privacy impact**

Do not claim an organisation has a blanket right to monitor all communications or that a generic warrant rule covers every investigatory power.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Explain both how lawful investigatory powers may support public safety and how safeguards protect privacy and civil liberties.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Interception Access during transit

Communications data Metadata about contact

Oversight Independent review

Proportionate No more than justified

1.5.1(d) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

A police investigation requests communications information

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Need	Find connections during a serious investigation	A defined purpose matters.
2. Scope	Numbers/timestamps vs message content	Different types of information raise different intrusions.
3. Authority	Apply the relevant statutory process	Permissions depend on the precise power and circumstances.
4. Safeguards	Authorisation, necessity and oversight	Legislation limits how powers may be exercised.
5. Balance	Privacy of uninvolved people	Use a proportionate, targeted approach where required.

EXAM TRANSFER

Explain both how lawful investigatory powers may support public safety and how safeguards protect privacy and civil liberties.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.1(d) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate a proposal to collect communications records while investigating serious crime. Discuss a benefit and two risks or safeguards.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why RIPA 2000 should be distinguished from later UK investigatory-powers law in a present-day answer.

1.5.1(d) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Records may help establish networks or timing relevant to an investigation.
- Broad collection risks intruding on uninvolved people.
- Applicable authorisation, necessity, proportionality and oversight protect rights.
- Different kinds of communications information can be governed differently.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- RIPA 2000 is named in the OCR specification.
- Later legislation, including the Investigatory Powers Act 2016, governs or amended parts of the modern framework.
- Specific powers require checking the current applicable law.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

"The government can read everything" and "every request needs the same warrant" are both unjustified blanket statements.

Green pen: Qualify claims about lawful authority: it depends on the power, purpose and process.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Automation changes tasks, not only job totals

Computing can raise productivity, create roles, and remove or transform tasks. Ethical evaluation must recognise uneven effects on workers, businesses and service users.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

OPPORTUNITY

Automate repetitive work, improve accuracy and free time for complex or human-centred tasks.

RISK

Displacement, deskilling, surveillance and unequal access to training can harm groups.

RESPONSE

Reskilling, human oversight, consultation and redesigning roles can share benefits more fairly.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Automate routine task → **Change job requirements** → **Assess affected groups** → **Support fair transition**

A warehouse robot may reduce repetitive lifting while changing staffing, training needs and worker safety responsibilities.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

A strong discussion weighs an outcome for named stakeholders and proposes realistic mitigation, rather than asserting all automation is good or bad.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Automation	Machine-performed tasks	**Deskilling**	Reduced skill use
Reskilling	Learning new tasks	**Stakeholder**	Affected group

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

A supermarket introduces automated checkout

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Customer	Potentially shorter queue	Depends on usability, reliability and staffing.
2. Business	Routine transactions need fewer staff minutes	Savings may be reinvested or reduce employee hours.
3. Staff	More exception-handling and customer support	Roles can change, not simply disappear.
4. Equity	Some customers need assistance	Accessibility and human support are important.
5. Response	Training + assisted checkout	Balances efficiency and inclusion.

EXAM TRANSFER

A strong discussion weighs an outcome for named stakeholders and proposes realistic mitigation, rather than asserting all automation is good or bad.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate the impact of introducing automated checkouts on employees, customers and the retailer.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain how reskilling can change the ethical impact of workplace automation.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Retailer may lower routine staffing cost and gain speed.
- Employees may face role change or reduced hours, creating unequal impact.
- Customers may gain convenience but some need accessible human assistance.
- Training and staffed alternatives mitigate disadvantages.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Reskilling prepares workers for new technical or support tasks.
- It reduces barriers to taking redesigned roles.
- It does not guarantee every displaced worker can remain employed.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Automation does not necessarily mean zero jobs; the nature and distribution of work matter.

Green pen: Use at least two stakeholders and link benefits/costs to each.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

A prediction is not automatically a fair decision

Algorithms can assess applications at scale but encode assumptions about data, thresholds and acceptable errors. People affected by significant decisions may need safeguards and opportunities to challenge outcomes.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

ADVANTAGE

Fast and consistent rule application; transparent rules can reduce arbitrary differences.

RISK

Proxy variables, incomplete records and rigid cut-offs can produce unfair exclusions.

SAFEGUARD

Audit outcomes, explain factors where appropriate, support correction and human challenge.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Training data and rules → **Model score / threshold** → **Automated outcome** → **Human review + appeal**

A student with a score just below a threshold may have very different circumstances from another with a slightly higher score.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Evaluate input quality, decision logic, impact and safeguards. Current UK rules for significant automated decisions are nuanced and were amended by the 2025 Act.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Threshold** Decision boundary
- **Bias** Systematic unfairness
- **Explainability** Can reasons be given?
- **Appeal** Challenge an outcome

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Review a bursary eligibility algorithm

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Inputs	Attendance and family income	Check whether fields are accurate and appropriate.
2. Rule	Reject applications with attendance < 90%	A rigid boundary may misrepresent illness-related absence.
3. Output	Automatic refusal	High-stakes decision affects a named student.
4. Check	Compare outcomes across groups	Look for disparate or unfair impact.
5. Remedy	Correction + human review	Enable contextual evidence and a challenge route.

EXAM TRANSFER

Evaluate input quality, decision logic, impact and safeguards. Current UK rules for significant automated decisions are nuanced and were amended by the 2025 Act.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

A college uses a scoring algorithm to award financial support. Evaluate its risks and possible safeguards.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why a uniform numeric threshold might still produce an unfair outcome.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Fast and consistent processing can help large application volumes.
- Biased/incomplete data may disadvantage some students.
- A threshold can ignore context such as illness or caring responsibilities.
- Audits and a meaningful review/challenge route can mitigate risks.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Equal treatment by a fixed rule is not the same as fair outcomes.
- Relevant contextual differences can be missing from the input data.
- A hard threshold can change the result for very similar cases.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

“The computer is objective” is not a justification; designers chose the data, labels, rules and thresholds.

Green pen: Name one test you would run to discover an unfair outcome.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Assess accuracy, bias, accountability and trust

AI systems can recognise patterns and generate content, but outputs may be incorrect, unrepresentative or difficult to explain. Their deployment creates social and ethical questions beyond raw model accuracy.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

BENEFIT

Assist diagnosis, translation, accessibility, forecasting or routine document work.

RISK

Bias, hallucination, privacy leakage, manipulation and overreliance.

GOVERNANCE

Use representative evaluation, human oversight, disclosure and restrictions appropriate to stakes.

VISUAL EXPLANATION / FOLLOW THE RELATIONSHIP

DATA → MODEL → ERROR TEST → HUMAN REVIEW

Test error rates by group and severity. Recheck after deployment; performance can drift.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Match the strength of oversight to the consequences of error; do not say all AI applications have equal risk.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Training data	Learning examples	**Hallucination**	Unsupported output
False negative	Missed real case	**Human oversight**	Person can intervene

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Evaluate AI-assisted health triage

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Benefit	Prioritise urgent appointments	May reduce waiting time for some users.
2. Error	Urgent case incorrectly labelled low risk	False negative creates potential harm.
3. Bias	Group underrepresented in training	Model performance may vary across groups.
4. Control	Clinician review of high-impact outputs	A human can challenge or reverse an outcome.
5. Monitor	Track errors and complaints over time	Deployment conditions and data may change.

EXAM TRANSFER

Match the strength of oversight to the consequences of error; do not say all AI applications have equal risk.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Discuss the opportunities and risks of AI triage in a hospital. Recommend safeguards.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why 95% overall model accuracy does not establish that all groups are treated fairly.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Faster triage may help allocate staff and reduce delay.
- Incorrect urgent-case classification can harm a patient.
- Training-data imbalance can cause unequal error rates.
- Review, subgroup testing and continuous monitoring mitigate harm.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Overall accuracy may conceal very different subgroup error rates.
- Compare false-positive and false-negative rates across relevant groups.
- Representative evaluation is needed to test fairness.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

A confident AI-generated explanation may still be factually wrong or ungrounded.

Green pen: Use a concrete failure mode and name the person accountable for correcting it.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Assess the whole digital life cycle

Computing can reduce some travel and resource use while consuming energy, water and materials. Life-cycle assessment considers extraction, manufacturing, operation, repair and disposal.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

PRODUCTION

Mining, component manufacture and shipping use energy and raw materials.

OPERATION

Data centres and devices consume electricity; cooling may use water depending on design.

END OF LIFE

Reuse, repair and appropriate recycling can reduce demand for virgin materials and e-waste.

VISUAL EXPLANATION / FOLLOW THE RELATIONSHIP

MAKE — RUN — REPAIR — REUSE

Compare embodied impacts + operational impacts + end-of-life effects.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

A balanced answer states the environmental mechanism, who benefits, what is displaced and when a claimed saving might not occur.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **E-waste** Discarded electronics
- **Life cycle** Whole-product impacts
- **Embodied carbon** Production emissions
- **Rebound effect** Extra use offsets savings

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Compare replacing devices every year with every four years

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Manufacture	Each new device needs material + energy	Frequent replacement increases production impacts.
2. In use	A newer device may be more efficient	Operational benefits depend on electricity consumption and use.
3. Rebound	Faster device encourages more activity	Efficiency gains can be partly offset.
4. Repair	Battery and screen replacement	May extend life without replacing whole device.
5. Decision	Use life-cycle evidence	Compare total impacts for the actual scenario.

EXAM TRANSFER

A balanced answer states the environmental mechanism, who benefits, what is displaced and when a claimed saving might not occur.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate whether replacing every school laptop with a more efficient model is environmentally beneficial.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain how remote meetings can reduce emissions yet still have environmental costs.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Newer devices may consume less electricity in use.
- Manufacture, transport and disposal impose environmental costs.
- Repair or longer life may reduce material demand.
- Compare complete life-cycle impacts before recommending replacement.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Fewer journeys can reduce travel emissions.
- Devices, networks and data centres still consume energy.
- Net impact depends on what travel is replaced and how technology is used.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

The phrase “digital is paperless” does not mean an activity has zero environmental footprint.

Green pen: Use production, use and disposal in every high-mark environmental evaluation.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Freedom of expression and harm prevention can conflict

Online moderation can reduce illegal or harmful material but may remove legitimate discussion, restrict minority voices or create inconsistent enforcement. Judgements depend on context and rule design.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

SAFETY

Moderation can limit harassment, threats and illegal material.

FREEDOM

Overbroad filters risk suppressing lawful discussion, satire or public-interest reporting.

PROCESS

Clear rules, proportionate action, transparency and appeals can improve accountability.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Set rules and reasons → **Flag content** → **Human / contextual review** → **Appeal and audit**

An automated block on a keyword cannot reliably understand every quotation, dialect, reclaimed term or satire.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Evaluate both the harms of leaving content visible and the harms of removing lawful speech; avoid an absolute stance without evidence.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Censorship** Suppression of expression
- **Moderation** Content rule enforcement
- **False positive** Legitimate item blocked
- **Appeal** Challenge removal

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

A platform automatically removes posts containing a term

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Aim	Protect users from abuse	A legitimate safety interest.
2. Filter	Match a prohibited word	Cheap and fast, but lacks context.
3. Error	Historical quotation incorrectly removed	False positive affects legitimate speech.
4. Review	Appeal to contextual human review	Can correct mistakes but costs time.
5. Publish	Explain rules and outcomes	Lets people judge policy consistency.

EXAM TRANSFER

Evaluate both the harms of leaving content visible and the harms of removing lawful speech; avoid an absolute stance without evidence.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate an online platform using automated keyword filters to moderate conversations between students.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why a transparent appeals process is important when content is removed automatically.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Filters can act quickly on common harmful patterns.
- May wrongly block legitimate context such as quotations or satire.
- Human review and clear rules help reduce false positives.
- Provide appeal process and proportionate responses.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Users can challenge mistakes and supply context.
- Corrections reduce wrongful exclusion and promote accountability.
- An appeal process does not guarantee a correct first decision.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

A rule that targets harmful abuse can still be implemented in an unfair or overbroad way.

Green pen: Identify the error type and the stakeholder before proposing a moderation policy.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Being able to monitor does not justify every use

Workplaces, schools and services may log activity for security, performance or welfare. Pervasive monitoring can harm privacy, trust, autonomy and relationships between people.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

LEGITIMATE USE

Security alerts, fraud detection, safeguarding and troubleshooting may need limited monitoring.

POTENTIAL HARM

Continuous surveillance can chill behaviour, misclassify harmless activity and reduce trust.

GOOD DESIGN

Define purpose, limit data and retention, inform users, restrict access and review proportionality.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Purpose → **Collect only needed events** → **Secure / limit access** → **Review necessity**

A system logging failed logins is different from recording every private message and keystroke.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

The best answer compares a less intrusive method with a more intrusive alternative and judges whether the extra data is necessary.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Telemetry Usage measurements

Chilling effect Behaviour changes

Proportionality Appropriate to aim

Retention Storage duration

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Consider staff-laptop monitoring

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Aim	Investigate repeated account lockouts	Security-focused purpose.
2. Option A	Log failed sign-ins	Targeted low-volume data may suffice.
3. Option B	Capture all typed messages	Much more intrusive; likely excessive for the aim.
4. Controls	Access limits and retention policy	Lower privacy and misuse risks.
5. Evaluate	Ask staff and review outcomes	Trust and accuracy matter alongside security.

EXAM TRANSFER

The best answer compares a less intrusive method with a more intrusive alternative and judges whether the extra data is necessary.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate an employer recording employees' screen activity throughout the day.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Distinguish targeted security logs from continuous surveillance, with one ethical issue for each.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Monitoring may identify misuse or assist support teams.
- Continuous recording may invade privacy and erode trust.
- Activity metrics can misrepresent actual work quality.
- Targeted logs, transparency and retention limits reduce harm.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Targeted logs capture events relevant to a stated security issue.
- Continuous surveillance captures much more personal behaviour.
- Even necessary logs need controls; continuous capture demands stronger justification.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

A manager owning the devices does not automatically make every kind of monitoring ethically or legally justified.

Green pen: Use the purpose and data collected to judge proportionality.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Useful insight can become unfair profiling

Personal-data analysis can improve services or detect problems, but combining datasets can reveal sensitive patterns and affect people who never expected the new use.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

BENEFIT

Find service gaps, detect fraud or identify individuals needing support.

RISK

Re-identification, secondary uses, bias and opaque profiling.

CONTROL

Purpose limitation, minimisation, fairness checks and appropriate aggregation or anonymisation.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Collect records → **Join datasets** → **Infer / predict pattern** → **Assess impact and safeguards**

Removing names is not automatically anonymisation if other attributes can identify a person when combined.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Explain how a new inference is generated, why it may harm a particular group and which specific technical or governance control can reduce harm.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Profiling** Inferring characteristics
- **Re-identification** Identity recovered
- **Aggregation** Group-level summary
- **Secondary use** New purpose for data

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Analyse travel-card records and shopping data

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Original	Journey data for fare payments	People expect the data to support travel.
2. Join	Link location + purchases	New combined data reveals richer personal patterns.
3. Risk	Unique routes reveal a person	An “anonymous” record may be re-identifiable.
4. Use	Plan services from grouped totals	Aggregated trends may achieve the purpose with less intrusion.
5. Review	Assess purpose and appropriate lawful basis	Extra use needs its own justification and safeguards.

EXAM TRANSFER

Explain how a new inference is generated, why it may harm a particular group and which specific technical or governance control can reduce harm.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate a council combining library, transport and benefits data to target services.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain how removing names from a dataset may still leave a privacy risk.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Joined data may identify underserved groups and improve resource allocation.
- Linking detailed records can expose sensitive or unexpected patterns.
- Risk of wrong inference or disproportionate impact on groups.
- Use justified purpose, access restriction, aggregation and bias testing.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Combinations such as unique location/time patterns may still identify someone.
- External datasets can enable re-identification.
- Aggregating or appropriately anonymising data may reduce this risk.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Pseudonymised data can still be personal data; it is not automatically fully anonymous.

Green pen: Name what can be inferred that could not easily be seen from one dataset alone.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Separate legal restrictions, social harm and platform policy

Digital copying can be nearly costless, and online communication can spread quickly. Evaluate rights and harms separately: copyright infringement, abusive communications and content-policy breaches are not interchangeable.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

PIRACY

Unauthorised copying/distribution can damage creators' revenue and may breach copyright.

OFFENSIVE MESSAGES

Targeted harassment or threatening communications can cause distress and exclusion.

BALANCE

Enforcement should distinguish unlawful conduct from unpopular but lawful expression.

VISUAL MODEL / TRACK THE DECISION

Identify the actual conduct → **Determine rights / harms** → **Apply proportionate response** → **Offer education / appeal**

A platform removing a post under its terms of service is not itself proof that the speaker committed a criminal offence.

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

In an extended answer identify the type of harm, responsible stakeholder and remedy; do not merge every objectionable online act into one law.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

- **Piracy** Unauthorised distribution
- **Harassment** Targeted abuse
- **Terms of service** Platform contract
- **Takedown** Removal request

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Respond to two unrelated digital incidents

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Incident A	Student uploads a paid video course	Potential infringement of the owner's copyright.
2. Mitigation A	Licence or legitimate access	Creators can be paid and users have clear permissions.
3. Incident B	Repeated targeted threatening messages	Potential serious harm; relevant law depends on context.
4. Mitigation B	Report, preserve evidence, protect users	Provide a proportionate safety response.
5. Distinguish	Two distinct issues	Do not call all offensive speech “copyright piracy”.

EXAM TRANSFER

In an extended answer identify the type of harm, responsible stakeholder and remedy; do not merge every objectionable online act into one law.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Discuss the effects of illegal file sharing and repeated offensive messages on users, creators and platforms.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why a platform's content removal does not necessarily prove a criminal offence.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Creators may lose income or control when work is distributed without permission.
- Users may face harmful, threatening or distressing communication.
- Platforms need fair reporting, review and enforcement processes.
- Education, licensing and proportionate moderation address different harms.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Platform rules can prohibit conduct that is still lawful.
- Criminal liability depends on the elements of the relevant offence and circumstances.
- A takedown or moderation decision is not a court determination.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

“Offensive” is not by itself a precise universal legal category; specifics and context matter.

Green pen: Keep copyright consequences and communications harms in separate parts of the answer.

1.5.2(a) / BUILD THE MENTAL MODEL

Design for different languages, cultures and users

Interfaces are experienced through language, reading direction, symbols, layout and colour. A design that works for one audience may confuse or exclude another; localisation goes beyond translation.

THREE PIECES OF THE IDEA

LAYOUT

Right-to-left languages may need mirrored navigation and text alignment; layouts should be tested.

COLOUR

Colour meanings differ across cultures and cannot be the only signal for meaning or state.

CHARACTERS

Unicode-capable storage and fonts support many scripts; rendering and input methods also matter.

VISUAL EXPLANATION / FOLLOW THE RELATIONSHIP

LEFT-TO-RIGHT

Home > Results

One reading convention

RIGHT-TO-LEFT

< Results Home

Another reading convention

EXAM-READY STATEMENT

Distinguish cultural localisation (beliefs, conventions, reading patterns) from accessibility, while explaining how the two can overlap.

WORDS THAT EARN MARKS

Localisation Adapt to locale

Unicode Character code points

RTL Right-to-left layout

Accessibility Inclusive usability

1.5.2(a) / STEP-BY-STEP SCENARIO

Localise an international competition registration page

Track what happens and why. Apply each point to the precise situation rather than repeating a memorised list.

SCENARIO / DECISION TABLE

STEP	ACTION / EVIDENCE	REASON / INTERPRETATION
1. Language	Offer translated text	Reduce comprehension barriers.
2. Layout	Support RTL where appropriate	Navigation flow can change with writing direction.
3. Form	Accept Unicode names	Avoid rejecting valid non-ASCII characters.
4. State	Success icon + written confirmation	Colour alone is ambiguous or inaccessible.
5. Validate	Test with users from target contexts	Reveal assumptions and cultural mismatches.

EXAM TRANSFER

Distinguish cultural localisation (beliefs, conventions, reading patterns) from accessibility, while explaining how the two can overlap.

Exam habit: point + scenario-specific evidence + consequence + considered judgement. Check any claim of law is accurate for its time and context.

1.5.2(a) / INDEPENDENT EXAM PRACTICE

Apply the idea without the model

Original teacher-written exam practice (not OCR past-paper material). Work in BLACK pen first; check the next page.

BLACK PEN: ANSWER FIRST. THEN CHECK THE SEPARATE MARK POINTS.

QUESTION 1 | 6 MARKS

Evaluate how an international sports-event website should handle layout, colour and character sets for a diverse audience.

QUESTION 2 | 4 MARKS

Explain why Unicode support alone does not guarantee a well-localised interface.

1.5.2(a) / SELF-MARKING / INDICATIVE ANSWERS

Self-mark, correct and explain

Check method and vocabulary, not just the final number. These are teacher-written points, not an OCR mark scheme.

Q1 / 6 MARKS

- Some users read RTL and need suitable alignment/navigation conventions.
- Colour meaning varies; pair colour with text/icons.
- Unicode is needed for many names and scripts but fonts/input must also work.
- Test translated interfaces with target audiences.

Q2 / 4 MARKS

- Unicode represents character identities, not page layout, translation or local conventions.
- Fonts, directional rendering and input methods must work.
- Content and visual signals still need cultural evaluation.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

“Use Unicode” is not a complete answer to cultural UI design; layout and colour are distinct concerns.

Green pen: Give one concrete language, colour or layout decision and link it to a user group.